

Rules of Inference

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1. Modus Ponens (Law of Detachment)

If a conditional statement is true and its condition is satisfied, the conclusion must be true.

If $p \rightarrow q$ and p , then q

2. Modus Tollens (Law of Contrapositive)

If a conditional statement is true, and its consequent is false, then its antecedent must also be false.

If $p \rightarrow q$ and $\neg q$, then $\neg p$

3. Hypothetical Syllogism

If two conditional statements are true, where the consequent of the first is the antecedent of the second, then a third conditional statement combining the antecedent of the first and the consequent of the second is also true.

If $p \rightarrow q$ and $q \rightarrow r$, then $p \rightarrow r$

4. Disjunctive Syllogism

If a disjunction is true, and one of its parts is false, then the other part must be true.

If $p \vee q$ and $\neg p$, then q

5. Conjunction

If two statements are true, then their conjunction is also true.

If p and q , then $p \wedge q$

6. Simplification

If a conjunction is true, then each of its conjuncts are also true.

If $p \wedge q$, then p

7. Addition

If a statement is true, then the disjunction of that statement with any other statement is also true.

If p , then $p \vee q$

8. Absorption

If a conditional statement is true, then the antecedent implies a conjunction of itself and the consequent.

If $p \rightarrow q$, then $p \rightarrow (p \wedge q)$

9. Resolution

If two disjunctions are true, and one containing proposition p while the other contains its negation $\neg p$, then the disjunction of the remaining parts is true.

If $p \vee q$ and $\neg p \vee r$, then $q \vee r$